

India signs deal for establishing MSME technology centres

India has signed a US\$ 200 million loan agreement with World Bank to help small enterprises enhance their productivity by financing the set-up of technology centres. The programme aims to set-up 15 technology centres and modernise the existing 18 centres.

The pact was signed by Tarun Bajaj, joint secretary, Ministry of Finance, on behalf of India and Onno Ruhl, country director of World Bank, on behalf of World Bank.

The project will help increase productivity of MSMEs by improving their access to technology and business advisory services. It will also help skilled workers via financially-sustainable technology centres.

India releases draft policy for IoT sector

A draft policy has been released by Department of Electronics and Information Technology (DeitY) on Internet of Things. According to DeitY, IoT industry holds a potential of US\$ 15 billion by 2020. IoT is the latest trend in the technology industry, which integrates smart technology with electronic devices. Its vast network connects everything from door locks, wearable devices to waste control systems.

The policy has been drafted to look into the issue as to why Indian market is still lagging behind in the booming industry. Companies are looking at huge potential from IoT-related work and local software developers such as Infosys, Wipro, HCL Technologies and Tech Mahindra. These local tech tycoons are working hard to hold strong positions in the IoT market.

The policy focuses on five main issues—create demonstration centres, capacity building along with incubation, focus on R&D sector for better in-

Andy Rubin, Android co-founder leaves Google

Andy Rubin, Android co-founder and the current head of its nascent robotics effort, is leaving the company with plans to set-up an incubator for all those start-ups interested in developing technology hardware products. He joined Google in 2005.

Sundar Pichai joins Google

Android and Chrome OS chief, India-born Sundar Pichai was appointed head of major products and services as part of restructuring of the management board of the company. Google products to be led by Pichai are main search, maps, advertising units, Google+, commerce and infrastructure. He will continue to fulfil his prior engagement in Android, Chrome and Apps business verticals. Pichai will also head six executives including heads of research, social media and search.

Synechron appoints MD for Middle East

Vimal Sethi has been appointed managing director, Synechron Middle East. This appointment highlights the company's strategic ambition to solve the toughest technological challenges for clients, offer high-end, skilled resources and 24x7 global delivery capabilities. Sethi will be responsible for driving expansion plans across MENA region.

Canon India's EVP moves to Singapore

Dr Alok Bharadwaj, EVP, Canon India, will be moving to Canon Singapore to head their corporate strategy group as senior VP. The change will be effective from January 1, 2015. He will be responsible for strategic business planning and execution, as well as corporate communications, for Canon's South East & South Asian regional operations. He will also oversee business development in emerging Asian markets in the region.

novation, better incentives and human resource development.

Union government approves ₹ 5000 million for solar parks in Andhra Pradesh

A grant of ₹ 5000 million has been approved by the central government for setting-up of 2500MW solar parks in Andhra Pradesh. The state government has planned to develop 500MW grid-connected solar PV projects. Bids for 1296MW have already been placed by around 50 solar developers.

AP Transco opened the auctioning process and bidders have offered tariff rates ranging from ₹ 5.25 to ₹ 8.08 per unit for the first year, with a three

per cent hike every year up to ten years. After the 11th year, there will be no increase in tariff rates.

The lowest tariff rate of ₹ 5.25 per unit for 40MW in Ananthapur district has been offered by First Solar Power India Pvt Ltd. This district is on top priority for all bidders as the bid in this district has been set at 580MW, followed by Chittoor at 273MW and Kurnool at



A solar park

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